Read the text below and answer the questions.

COMMUNICATION OVERLOAD

Communication overload is a common challenge for many employees, especially in the era of remote work and digital tools. It can lead to stress, confusion, lower productivity, and reduced engagement. How can you cope with the constant flow of messages, emails, calls, and notifications? Here are some tips to improve your internal communication skills and create a more balanced and effective communication culture.

1 Define your communication goals

Before you send or request any information, ask yourself: what is the purpose of this communication? What are the expected outcomes and actions? By clarifying your communication goals, you can avoid unnecessary or irrelevant messages, prioritize the most important ones, and use the most suitable channels and formats.

2 Respect your audience's preferences and needs

Not everyone communicates in the same way or has the same availability and preferences. Some people may prefer emails over calls, while others may favour instant messaging or video conferencing. Some people may need more details and explanations, while others may want concise and clear summaries. Some people

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may have different time zones, schedules, or workloads. Respect your audience's preferences and needs by asking for their feedback, adapting your communication style, and being mindful of their context and constraints.

3 Use the right tools and platforms

There are many tools and platforms available for communication, such as email, chat, phone, video, intranet, social media, and collaboration software. Each one has its own advantages and disadvantages, depending on the type, frequency, urgency, and complexity of the communication. Use the right tools and platforms for your communication goals, and avoid using too many or switching between them unnecessarily.

4 Filter and organize your information

One of the main causes of communication overload is the lack of filtering and organizing of information. Filter and organize your information by using labels, folders, categories, tags, filters, and search functions. Create a system that helps you sort, prioritize, and access the information you need, and delete or archive the information you don't need.

5 Set boundaries and expectations

Another cause of communication overload is the lack of boundaries and expectations. When you feel that you have to respond to every message or request immediately, or that you have to be available at all times, you can experience stress, burnout, and reduced work-life balance. Set boundaries and expectations by establishing clear and realistic deadlines, response times, and communication

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hours. Turn off or mute your notifications when you need to focus, take breaks, or enjoy your personal time.

6 Communicate with empathy and respect

Finally, the most important internal communication skill is to communicate with empathy and respect. Communication overload can affect your emotions, moods, and attitudes, and lead to misunderstandings, conflicts, or resentment. Communicate with empathy and respect by listening actively, acknowledging feelings, expressing appreciation, giving constructive feedback, apologizing when needed, and resolving issues constructively. By communicating with empathy and respect, you can build trust, rapport, and engagement, and foster a positive and supportive communication culture.

Adopted from:

https://www.linkedin.com/advice/0/how-can-you-help-employees-dealcommunication#:~:text=Communication%20overload%20is%20a%20common,low er%20productivity%2C%20and%20reduced%20engagement.

Task

How do you cope with the constant flow of messages, emails, calls, and notifications? Do they effect your emotions and moods?

1. My way to cope is muting notifications, scheduled check times, folders/filters.

2. In my view, a lack of boundaries causes anxiety and stress, whereas establishing boundaries leads to calm and a positive mood.

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Write 100 words to get 1-2 extra points on your exam.

The constant flow of messages, emails, and notifications can easily become overwhelming and negatively affect my focus and stress levels. Constant interruptions make me feel anxious and reduce my productivity, especially when I am coding or studying complex subjects.

To cope with this communication overload, I establish strict boundaries. First, I mute non-urgent notifications during my deep work sessions to protect my concentration. Second, I check and answer emails only at scheduled times during the day instead of reacting immediately. Finally, I organize messages using filters and folders. This proactive approach helps me stay calm, maintain a positive mood, and work much more efficiently.

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